

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-09-23

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 13:9-14

9 And when they came to Chidon's threshing floor, Uzza put out his hand to hold the ark, for the oxen stumbled.

10 Then the anger of the Lord was aroused against Uzza, and He struck him because he put his hand to the ark; and he died there before God.

11 And David became angry because of the Lord's outbreak against Uzza; therefore that place is called Perez Uzza to this day.

12 David was afraid of God that day, saying, "How can I bring the ark of God to me?"

13 So David would not move the ark with him into the City of David, but took it aside into the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite.

14 The ark of God remained with the family of Obed-Edom in his house three months. And the Lord blessed the house of Obed-Edom and all that he had.

II. Key Summary

- When the procession reached Chidon's threshing floor, the oxen stumbled and Uzza put out his hand to hold the ark; the Lord's anger was aroused, He struck Uzza, and Uzza died there before God.
 - David became angry and named the place "Perez Uzza"; that day he was afraid of God and asked, "How can I bring the ark of God to me?"
 - David did not bring the ark into the City of David but took it to the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite; it stayed there three months, and the Lord blessed Obed-Edom's household and everything he had.
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III. Passage Analysis

Good Intentions Still Need God's Way

David's anger was rooted in confusion. He couldn't understand why his good intentions weren't enough. God is concerned with both our intentions and our actions. [1]

David and Uzza truly wanted to bring the ark home, but they put it on a new ox cart instead of having the Levites carry it on their shoulders as God had commanded. Their hearts were in the right place, but a good heart can't replace listening to what God actually said.

First Reverence, Then Grace

God first taught David "reverence" by striking Uzza, and then taught him "grace" by blessing Obed-Edom's whole household, so that David would understand that love and zeal for God must be grounded in truth; only such service is the faithful service God accepts. [2]

The same ark brought death at Uzza's hand, yet brought three months of blessing to Obed-Edom's home. God wanted David to learn both to take Him seriously and to know He is ready to bless.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you "put out your hand" to help—a friend, your family, or at church—did you do it the way you thought was right, or did you first ask how it should be done?

Uzza's hand came from a good heart, but it wasn't God's way; later the ark was placed in the house of Obed-Edom, the Levite who was supposed to care for it (Numbers 4:15; 1 Chronicles 26:4), and the LORD blessed his household and all that he had (1 Chronicles 13:14).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on 1 Chronicles 13,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-13/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 1 Chronicles
Comprehensive Bible Study (on 1 Chr 13:13),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT13.htm>